



Discussion Guide: Cliff & Clay Price

"Growing Up Different in a Small Town"

Reflect

- Describe your experience of hearing Cliff and Clay's story about being young gay men growing up in a rural and conservative context. What about their story resonates with you, and why?
- Cliff and Clay suggest that it is "ok to be who you are...as long as you love." Has this been a message you have heard and seen lived out in your experience with institutional religion? How has this experience impacted your own spiritual journey?
- In music and the arts, Cliff and Clay found a place to authentically express themselves. What outlets or pursuits enable you to express your authentic self? Who are the people who have encouraged your passions and given you permission to be you?

Respond

- Cliff and Clay describe St. Luke's UMC Orlando as a faith community that is welcoming to everyone. Based on your experiences, what types of habits, practices, and lived values enable a faith community to be experienced as welcoming to everyone? What is your role in this work?
- Imagine TheoEd was coming to your area and you are tasked with selecting a local speaker who, much like Cliff and Clay, came to have a deep experience of belonging while involved with your church or community. Who would you choose? What sort of story do you think they would share?